



Satya Nadella

Chairman & Chief Executive Officer

1975

Founded

\$331.8B

FY2026 revenue

\$100B+

Azure annual revenue

30M

Copilot paid seats

\$678B

Commercial RPO

01 Who You're Meeting

Satya Nadella — Chairman & Chief Executive Officer, Microsoft.

In role: CEO since February 2014; Chairman since 2021

Today: Leads Microsoft through the AI platform shift — Azure past \$100B and accelerating, Copilot at 30 million paid seats, and a capital programme of roughly \$175B for calendar 2026.

A long-serving insider who came up through the enterprise businesses, which is why the cloud pivot worked. He ran the Server and Tools business before becoming CEO, and is widely credited with shifting Microsoft's culture from what he describes as know-it-all to learn-it-all. The strategic pattern he is known for is funding new businesses long before they become growth businesses — most visibly throttling back the Windows franchise to pay for the cloud investment that now underpins the company. He has stated that Microsoft holds royalty-free frontier model IP rights through 2032.

Career: Chief Executive Officer (Chairman from 2021), Microsoft; Executive Vice President, Cloud and Enterprise; led Server and Tools, Microsoft

The company: Azure crossed \$100B of annual revenue for the first time in FY2026 and accelerated to 43% growth in Q4 rather than plateauing. Microsoft 365 Copilot passed 30 million paid seats, doubling in two quarters, against a commercial base of roughly 464 million seats — so penetration is still only about 6.5%.

What they sell: Azure cloud and AI infrastructure, Microsoft 365 and the Copilot family, Dynamics 365 for ERP and CRM, GitHub, Fabric for data, and the security portfolio. Nadella has stated Microsoft holds royalty-free frontier model IP rights through 2032.

02 Where The Company Sits

Microsoft is the default enterprise AI route for most organisations because the commercial relationship already exists — Copilot lands inside an enterprise agreement rather than requiring a new vendor selection. That is genuinely important for a portfolio programme: it is the lowest-friction path to individual productivity across PortCos, which is one of the three opportunity areas in the reference model. Two numbers deserve attention in any negotiation.

03 Talking Points

- Enterprise-bred, not consumer — a conversation about deployment across a fragmented portfolio is his natural territory.
- Copilot penetration is roughly 6.5% of eligible seats. He knows the upsell runway is the story; volume commitments are where the leverage is.
- Escalation point above the account team, not a working counterpart. Reserve for portfolio-scale licensing.

What to pressure-test about the company:

- Free cash flow fell 23% while capex hit a record, with two thirds of that spend on assets Microsoft classifies as short-lived
- GAAP profit growth of 31% versus roughly 22% adjusted — the gap is a \$3.2B Anthropic investment gain, not operating performance
- From FY2027 Microsoft extends the useful life of data centres and office buildings from 15 to 25 years, which flatters future earnings

04 GIP Context

GIP: No publicly disclosed GIP relationship. Microsoft is near-certain to be present across multiple PortCos already through enterprise agreements, so the practical question is consolidated licensing terms rather than a first introduction.

BlackRock: No publicly disclosed operating relationship; standard index holdings of MSFT only.

Others at Microsoft: Amy Hood (Executive Vice President & Chief Financial Officer)

www.microsoft.com · [Microsoft FY2026 Q4 results](#) · [Fortune profile](#) · [Company LinkedIn](#)

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